

Rachel E. Dickson
Office of the Secretary
Federal Maritime Commission
800 North Capitol Street, N.W
Washington, DC 20573

Secretary Dickson:

My wife Robin and I made two bookings for an Alaskan cruise on Regent Seven Seas (RSSC) to celebrate my parent's 50th Anniversary and my mother's 70th birthday (booking #s 2375574 and 2375575). The cruise was set to sail June 17 through June 24, 2020. As part of the booking process, we provided deposits totaling \$7,646.40 (details below):

- Cruise deposits total (2): \$3,764.40 (\$1,792.20 and \$1972.20)
 - My parent's booking was slightly higher than Robin and my booking
- Excursions deposits total (4): \$3,892 (\$1,474, \$1,474, \$472 and \$472)
- **Total Deposit Amount: \$7,646.40**

Regent was requiring final payment no later than April 21, 2020 (the original March date was pushed out a few weeks). The final payment would have amounted to an additional \$21,331.60.

When the final payment date arrived, we were faced with a dilemma. Cancel the cruise and lose a large part of the deposit or send the final \$21,331.60 payment as the only way to guarantee a full refund if the cruise was cancelled. Based on where the four of us live (California) and the travel restrictions in place at the time (shelter in place orders), and my parents being in the most vulnerable demographic group known at the time (70+), we could not justify moving forward with a cruise. Additionally, at the time we made this decision, we knew the cruise would have to be cancelled since all cruises were shut down, Canada had blocked their ports, non-essential travel between the US and Canada was prohibited, and other companies (including those within the NCL portfolio) had already cancelled June Alaskan Cruises due to COVID and the associated restrictions.

With refund timelines quoted as 90 days and it being obvious the cruise would be cancelled imminently (based on other NCL owned cruise line decisions), sending \$21,331.60 to RSSC for them to hold for three months was not a reasonable option. Therefore, we cancelled with RSSC on April 21, 2021. The cruise was officially cancelled by RSSC on April 24, 2020 – three days after we cancelled our cruise. Because we were unwilling to provide RSSC with an additional \$21K to guarantee a full refund for a cruise that was all but assured to be cancelled due to the pandemic, **RSSC only refunded a total of \$4,132.00** (\$1,792.20, \$1972.20, \$183.80 and \$183.80).

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Date

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Based on the circumstances outlined above, the charges incurred and the refunds to date, RSSC owes us **\$3,514.40** (\$7,646.40 deposit - \$4,132.00 refunds). Robin and I would appreciate your consideration and assistance in requiring RSSC and other cruise lines to completely refund customer impacted by the situation above.

Sincerely,

David and Robin Schultz